GONÇALO MOREIRA NEVES

Horticultural LED Lighting

Commercial leadership for horticultural LED lighting: new markets, channels and growth

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Horticultural LED lighting executive with 17 years across photobiology research, LED product design, commercial leadership and C-suite operations. Took Valoya from its first deal to €10M+ revenue in 50+ countries through distributors and key accounts; as co-CEO of Lumatek (HID and LED) grew the segment 210% in 2025 and cut costs by ~60%; founded Spectron Light Science and sold it within 14 months. Engineer at the core (M.Sc. Illumination Engineering, Aalto) and commercial leader in practice: market expansion, channel and distributor building, pricing and key accounts across greenhouse horticulture, floriculture and vertical farming. Based in Lisbon, working in Portuguese, English and Spanish; open to CCO and International Commercial Director roles.

CORE SKILLS

- Commercial strategy: go-to-market, market expansion, pricing, customer segmentation, key-account growth
- Channel building: distributor and partner networks; market entry in 50+ countries across Europe, Asia and North America
- Horticultural LED lighting: photobiology, spectrum, PPFD / DLI and µmol/J design for greenhouses, floriculture and vertical farming
- Executive leadership: CEO / co-CEO, interim C-suite, transformation and turnaround, P&L ownership
- Business development and strategic partnerships across the CEA and lighting value chain
- Technical and commercial due diligence; capital raising and investor relations (seed to Series D)
- Hardware product development; illumination and electrical engineering; IoT, automation and robotics
- Organisational restructuring, culture change, and remote, cross-functional team leadership
- Stakeholder and board engagement; negotiation and influence
- AI-powered workflows and data-driven decision-making (ChatGPT, Perplexity, Claude)

WORK EXPERIENCE

Managing Partner | APTA Advisory

Lisbon, Portugal | Aug 2026 - Present

Independent due diligence and business strategy firm for CEA and horticulture.

- Lead the firm and its service model: CapEx and OpEx due diligence for buyers of lighting, climate and automation; strategy for suppliers
- Advise boards, investors and operations teams on investment cases, supplier selection, unit economics and value creation; own go-to-market, pricing and partnerships
- Designed an outcome-linked fee model (share of verified savings, or fixed fee)

co-CEO | Interim Chief of Sales & Marketing | Lumatek EU

Lisbon, Portugal | Dec 2024 - Jul 2026

Commercial transformation and growth of a 20-year horticultural lighting manufacturer (HID and LED).

- After growing the segment 210% in 2025, reached a 4x 2025 run-rate in Q1 2026, through targeted development and a repositioned product offer
- Created two new customer segments, expanding the addressable market beyond legacy channels
- Implemented a business cost-reduction strategy that cut overall business costs by ~60%, partnering with the CFO, COO and CPO
- Delivered a full commercial and cultural restructure: resized teams, closed underperforming markets, and opened new geographies and distribution channels
- Made the business data-driven and unified the commercial culture by breaking down internal silos between teams
- Hired and onboarded marketing and sales talent; left the business growing, commercially self-sustaining, and positioned for its next chapter

Independent Consultant | Gonçalo Neves Consulting
Lisbon, Portugal | Apr 2024 - Aug 2026

Strategic and technical advisory to investors and operators in Agri-Food Tech and CEA (clients under NDA).

- Conducted technical due diligence on CEA companies, products, and platforms for investment decisions
- Delivered competitive market analyses: technology trends, regulation, market share, and consumer preferences
- Developed and implemented value-creation frameworks and KPI benchmarks for startups and scale-ups
- Advised on go-to-market, pricing, and commercial team structure; delivered workshops and training

VP Business Development & Head of AgriTech Partnerships | IGS (Intelligent Growth Solutions)
Edinburgh / Amsterdam | Aug 2021 - Jul 2024

Award-winning vertical farming technology company; IoT-enabled, AI-driven, built on six families of patents (IGS shareholder).

- Contributed to raising Series B at €50M, achieving a €200M+ company valuation
- Opened two new revenue streams generating €20M+ (vertical-farming/greenhouse hybrid; young-plant producers and seed/breeding)
- Decreased product OpEx by up to 40% and CapEx/m2 by up to 15% through partnership and process integration
- Closed strategic partnerships with Schneider Electric, Viscon Group, Microsoft, Plant Lighting, and Wageningen University & Research
- Built and led the BD team; ran teams for lean business-case development, IP acquisition, and partnerships; reported to the CEO and COO

Director of Farm Hardware | Infarm
Berlin, Germany | Mar 2020 - Mar 2021

Hardware leadership at one of Europe's highest-profile vertical farming scale-ups.

- Achieved a 40% energy cost reduction per plant via a new HVAC design, a 61% rent cost reduction per m2 through technology integration, and +73% output per m2 via new growing techniques and space optimisation
- Contributed to raising Series D at €200M, €1B+ valuation
- Grew the team from ~40 to 100 people in one year and drove an 83% labour cost reduction per plant through automation
- Created cross-functional teams (crops, hardware, software, digital PM) and led the move to SAFe, Agile, Kanban and Flight Levels; migrated hardware management to JIRA

Entrepreneurial Experience (five ventures)
Amsterdam, Netherlands | Jun 2016 - Jan 2020

Founded and led five distinct businesses across AgriTech, lighting, consultancy, and education.

- Founder & CEO, Spectron Light Science (Nov 2016 - Dec 2017): designed and manufactured three horticultural LED product lines; company acquired by a major horticultural industry player within 14 months
- Founder & CTO, OneFarm BV (Jan 2017 - Jan 2020): led technology and product for large-scale vertical farm rollouts; raised a seed round (€1M, €5M+ valuation) and assisted a Series A (€9M, €36M+ valuation)
- Founder & CEO, BemStudio (Jun 2016 - May 2020): engineering and business consulting for AgTech and CEA clients
- Director, A Lab Vertical Farm (Jun 2017 - Dec 2019): ran a community vertical farm and trained ~50 volunteers in controlled-environment agriculture
- Guest Lecturer, Breitner Academie (Mar 2017 - Jun 2017): taught urban farming and food-technology innovation with hands-on rapid prototyping

Director of Business Development | Valoya
Helsinki, Finland / Netherlands | Jun 2011 - May 2016

Leading photobiology-driven LED grow-light company. Rose through three roles in five years: Technical Manager, Solution Manager, then Director of Business Development (joined as a minority shareholder).

- Closed the company's first commercial deal (€300,000+) and grew revenue from €0 to €10M+
- Expanded to 50+ countries across Europe, Southeast Asia, Japan, and North America; opened the Amsterdam office
- Developed and launched the company's first product lines; closed distribution partnerships in Japan and North America
- Identified new revenue streams (seed/breeding, research), repositioning on photobiology capability rather than raw efficiency

Researcher | **Aalto University**
Helsinki, Finland | Apr 2009 - May 2011

- Researched horticultural and solid-state lighting: usage and control of LEDs and their application in plant cultivation
- Projects: SSHLighting, Solid-State Horticulture Lighting (2009-2011); LEDFlowers, LED Luminaire for Plant Cultivation (2008-2011)

EDUCATION

Oxford Artificial Intelligence Programme, University of Oxford (starting)

Artificial Intelligence Ethics (specialization), Coursera (in progress)

AI Fundamentals for Non-Data Scientists, Wharton, University of Pennsylvania, Coursera (in progress)

M.Sc.(Tech.) Electrical Engineering (Illumination Engineering & Electrical Building Services), Aalto University, Finland (2010-2012)

M.Sc.(Minor) International Design Business Management, Aalto University, Finland (2011-2012)

B.Sc.(Tech.) Electromechanical Engineering, Universidade da Beira Interior, Portugal (2004-2009)

B.Sc. Erasmus Exchange, Electromechanical Engineering, Teknillinen korkeakoulu (now Aalto), Finland (2009)

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

- Lighting in Greenhouses and Vertical Farms, Wageningen University & Research (2018)
- Leading SAFe and Agile for Hardware, Gladwell Academy; Flight Levels, Flight Levels Academy
- Product Development Project, Design Factory, Aalto University; Mental Health First Aider, Worksafe (UK) Ltd

LANGUAGES

Portuguese: Native | English: Full professional | Spanish: Advanced | French: Basic | Finnish: Beginner

TECH STACK & TOOLS

- AI assistants: ChatGPT, Perplexity, Claude (web, Cowork, Design, Code)
- CRM: HubSpot, Salesforce | BI & analytics: Tableau | ERP systems
- Project management: JIRA, Asana, Monday, Confluence | Agile: SAFe, Flight Levels, Kanban
- Productivity: Microsoft 365, Google Workspace

PUBLICATIONS & MEMBERSHIPS

- Co-Author, Advances in Plant Factories: New Technologies in Indoor Vertical Farming (Part 6, Ch. 20), Burleigh Dodds Science Publishing, 2023
- Author, Lighting Units and Measurements in Plant Cultivation, Aalto University, 2014
- Co-Author, Valotusta tarpeen mukaan (real-time dynamic lighting in cultivation), International Review of Civil Engineering, 2011
- Member, International Society for Horticultural Science (ISHS)